

End-of-Life Care Policy

SECTIONS 1-6

1 PURPOSE

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that every resident of Chosanta Management receives compassionate, dignified, and person-centred care as they approach the end of life.

Our commitment is to:

- ✓ Promote comfort, respect, and quality of life in the final stages of life
- ✓ Honour the cultural, spiritual, and personal values and wishes of each resident
- ✓ Support residents, their families, and significant others with sensitivity and empathy
- ✓ Provide a structured framework for staff to deliver consistent and high-quality end-of-life care
- ✓ Ensure compliance with national standards, ethical principles, and relevant legislation, including the Health Act 2007 and HIQA's National Standards

2 SCOPE

This policy applies to all staff, healthcare professionals, volunteers, and associated care partners involved in the care of residents approaching the end of life within Chosanta Management.

3 PRINCIPLES

- ✓ Respect for the dignity, rights, and wishes of each resident
- ✓ Holistic and individualised care planning
- ✓ Effective communication and collaboration with residents, families, and healthcare teams
- ✓ Provision of physical, emotional, psychological, spiritual, and social support
- ✓ Advance care planning and early identification of end-of-life needs
- ✓ Compliance with legal and ethical standards, including the Assisted Decision-Making (Capacity) Act 2015

4 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Manager / Person in Charge (PIC):** Ensures policy implementation, staff training, and coordination with palliative care teams
- ✓ **Care Staff:** Deliver compassionate care and promptly report changes in condition
- ✓ **Clinical Staff:** Develop and review end-of-life care plans, administer pain relief, and liaise with palliative teams
- ✓ **All Staff:** Respect confidentiality and support family members and other residents during and after the end-of-life process

5 ADVANCE CARE PLANNING

- ✓ Encourage residents (and families, where appropriate) to discuss preferences for end-of-life care early in the care process
- ✓ Record wishes regarding resuscitation (DNAR), place of death, spiritual or cultural practices, and pain management preferences
- ✓ Review plans regularly or when health conditions change

6 PALLIATIVE & COMFORT CARE

- ✓ Prioritise pain and symptom management in accordance with clinical guidelines
- ✓ Offer support from multidisciplinary teams, including palliative care specialists, as needed
- ✓ Facilitate spiritual or religious rites in accordance with the resident's beliefs

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7 FAMILY INVOLVEMENT

- ✓ Include families in care planning where appropriate
- ✓ Provide emotional support and practical information throughout the dying process
- ✓ Allow flexible visiting and overnight stays when a resident is nearing death

8 ENVIRONMENT & DIGNITY

- ✓ Ensure a peaceful, private, and respectful environment
- ✓ Support cultural, religious, and personal rituals before and after death
- ✓ Handle the deceased with dignity and ensure families are given time to say goodbye

9 AFTER-DEATH PROTOCOL

- ✓ Notify relevant authorities and professionals promptly
- ✓ Respect the resident's and family's wishes regarding funeral arrangements
- ✓ Offer bereavement support to families and staff
- ✓ Record and report death in accordance with HIQA and legal requirements

10 STAFF TRAINING

All staff will receive training in end-of-life care, including communication skills, symptom management, and emotional support.

11 MONITORING & REVIEW

- ✓ Audits will be conducted annually or following any significant incident
- ✓ Feedback from families and staff will be reviewed to improve care standards
- ✓ This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner if required by changes in legislation or best practice